

Incident handler's journal

Date: 2026/11/9	**Entry:** **1**
Description	A security incident occurred at a small medical clinic in the United States, causing significant disruption to its business operations. The incident was orchestrated by a group of hackers. It was triggered by a phishing email containing a malicious attachment, which ultimately led to the deployment of ransomware that paralyzed the organization's systems.
Tool(s) used	Log
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **The incident took place on a Tuesday at 9:00 AM at a small medical clinic in the United States. It was initiated by a group of hackers who sent phishing emails to the clinic's staff, tricking them into downloading an attachment. The attachment contained ransomware, which then infiltrated the system. The hackers used this ransomware to encrypt the organization's files and left a ransom note. The incident occurred because an employee was deceived, inadvertently assisting the hackers in gaining access to the system to carry out the attack. The hackers' motive was financial gain; they sought to extract a ransom from the organization.** • **Who: An organized group of unethical hackers** • **● What: A ransomware security incident** • **● Where: At a health care company** • **● When: Tuesday 9:00 a.m.**

	• **● Why: The incident happened because unethical hackers were able to access the company's systems using a phishing attack. After gaining access, the attackers launched their ransomware on the company's systems, encrypting critical files. The attackers' motivation appears to be financial because the ransom note they left demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.**
Additional notes	Does the organization have an email filtering mechanism in place, and is it effective? Does the organization provide regular security awareness training for its employees? How could the health care company prevent an incident like this from occurring again? 2. Should the company pay the ransom to retrieve the decryption key?